

OREGON CITY COURIER

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DOING BUSINESS

Mention has before been made on this page of the habit Oregon City's council has of not transacting public business as it would transact the personal business of its members. Some of the council have protested that "former councils" may have been negligent in this way, but have assured us that the present council was a model, and was devoted to the interests of the taxpayers. Last week's council session was further "proof" of this.

A sexton was to be selected for the coming term. The former sexton's name was placed in nomination, as was the name of an opponent. The Council knows nothing as to the qualifications of either the old or the new sexton, and is not here discussing their merits. Four of the nine councilmen voted for the former sexton, and four voted for the newly proposed man. The ninth councilman first wrote the name of the former sexton on his ballot, then erased it and wrote the name of the newly proposed candidate, who thus won the place by the odd vote.

After the council session three of the city fathers concerned in the matter "met on the corner" and expressed their opinions of one another. It then developed that "the solid five" had determined on the re-election of the former sexton, but that one of the group, angered at what he regarded as a "double cross" slipped him on another matter of city business, had switched his vote to "get even." When they pull off stuff like this in the legislature they call it log-rolling. When it is done in the city council, the members protest that they are transacting the city's business as they would their own, and that criticism of them is unjust.

Do you reckon a business man would hire his help to spite another man, or according to the qualifications of the applicant?

TELLING THE TRUTH

The better the day the better the deed; so on Sunday the Enterprise wakes up and tells us that there are less idle freight cars in the United States than previously. But lest we think that freight cars are busily engaged in service, and so reflect prosperity in our land under the Democratic administration, the Enterprise explains that "idle cars" are really "surplus cars," and that the railroads are wearing out cars so fast now that they have to draw on the "surplus cars" for more. Hence, says the Enterprise, there is no business activity or prosperity.

Well, what do you suppose is wearing out the freight cars so that the "idle cars" have to be substituted for the worn out ones? If there isn't any business being done, why are cars wearing out? When freight cars stand still, do they drop to pieces in democratic years? And if there is not any unusual business being done by the railroads, why do cars have to be replaced, anyway? The Courier would be pleased to have the republican sheet down the street go into this matter some more—seeing as they have opened the question.

If business is rotten, if the railroads are not reflecting any general business activity, if the "idle cars" are not needed, why are they being used to replace cars that are being worn out? And what is wearing these cars out? We know the Enterprise will be glad to explain this matter, for the Enterprise always tells the truth. The day after the Enterprise had its spasm about the lessening of the number of idle freight cars being no proof of prosperity, the Oregonian—another good, old, republican, stand pat paper, shouted on its front page "Business losing feeling of doubt; confidence in future becomes profound; even war is not feared." The Oregonian says that four of this nation's being dragged into war was what held business back, but that now business is so very "busy" that "even war is not feared." Maybe the Enterprise had better read the Oregonian, and then change its stand—as it has done before.

We know the Enterprise likes to be truthful—even Mr. Templeton says it is written with one arm of the edi-

tor perched upon the Holy Writ—so we trust that the dinky little sheet down the street will go further into this matter of busy and worn out freight cars and TELL THE TRUTH.

POLITICS

Lack of torrid weather this year has so far prevented the usual epidemic of "midsummer madness" which the average American is wont to enjoy during August. It is true that the papers inform us that society women in the east have taken to going about without their stockings, and it is also true that certain youths of the "younger set" persist in wearing shirtwaists with rolling collars and low necks instead of clothes—but these are only minor manifestations. And here in Clackamas county we haven't had any midsummer madness at all, so in lieu of this folk have taken a step in advance of the season and have commenced to stir the political pot.

It isn't ethics to stir up the political stew in Oregon before fall. Of course politics are a steady and persistent industry in the Beaver state, but they usually just simmer. Yet here we are with August not yet half gone, and everybody is figuring on what is going to happen at elections that are so far off that the newspapers haven't even started figuring their losses on defeated candidates' bills. It is wrong to talk politics now; a hot wave may break loose anytime and then there will be all kinds of trouble, for the average American can't work politics when it is warm by the thermometer. He gets too hot under the collar over politics, and when hot weather is added to it, things are liable to happen.

It is the duty of all good citizens, therefore, to put a quietus on politics whenever the chance arises. There is talk in the county seat of a fight for mayor's place. This talk ought to be hushed—for there hasn't been anybody mentioned yet who can get the job. There is wrangling over the next council, just as if the present one wasn't bad enough. And outside of the county seat there is gum-shoe hunting of county jobs. Quite a bunch of folks want to be sent to Salem at the expense of their neighbors, there to see how many laws they can pass, and how much of an appropriation record they can make. And down in Portland there are trying to alibi and whitewash each other so they can find a man to run for federal senator—a man whose record can be printed by the big dailies without fracturing the laws in regard to the purity of printed matter.

All this is unseasonable, and should be stopped. There is too much chance of hot weather ahead, and if a belated midsummer madness hits the early political mill there will be terrible things happen. Under such excitement Chris Schuebel might think he was called to run for congress, or Al Price might declare himself a candidate for mayor, or Lloyd Riches might get the hunch that he ought to be councilman. Politics and summer don't mix, and if people persist in mixing them the Courier is going to expose some of the weird and wonderful ambitions that have been confidentially revealed to it.

PASSING COMMENTS

Our friend and fellow intelligencer, the Enterprise, says among other things: "The second fire in two days in Clackamas county due to the explosion of a kerosene Saturday night"—and so on. It must have been quite a large lamp that exploded, to start two fires, two days apart.

When a socialist or an anarchist preaches "birth control," a hundred dollar fine is handed out by Justice. But when "society folks" are not at all bothered by children, everybody thinks it's just too nice for anything. The difference is one set may talk about it, the others don't say a word.

An eastern paper informs us that "moss green and pink are to be used in suits for men." And they say it is the dictate of Dame Fashion. Most men, we notice, say Dame Fashion's name as if the first part of the title was spelled without the "e."

The Rev. Charles F. Aked has removed himself from the "committee of 100" that is going to manage Billy Sunday in California because he can't agree with Billy as to his description of hell and heaven. When the reverend fell out and differ on this subject, is it any wonder that common folk sometimes have doubts, too?

WHO IS MOLLYCODDLE?

"In time of peace men and women are docile asses for production. In time of war they are docile asses for the war machines. The war baby is brought into the world because the machine of government and war realizes that unless the young man is the father of a child before he is slaughtered in the trenches there will be no gun fodder for the machine in the next generation. Therefore the church machine sanctions war brides and the bishop in his robes sanctifies marriages a hundred at a time in holy haste to enable slaughtering to go on at the front and women to be burdened with children in poverty and anguish at home."

The man who spoke the above was the celebrated Dr. C. H. Chapman of Portland.

He didn't deliver his speech from a soap box on a street corner, to the men in overalls and the women in calico, but he spoke to the Women's Civic Welfare club in the central library, to the women of wealth and culture. His subject was "War Brides."

Any woman who uses the reasoning power that God gives to mothers, and any mother who has bent over a cradle and anxiously watched a baby in sickness—that mother must say "amen" to the talk of Dr. Chapman. Chapman told the ladies of the Civic Welfare club a lot of plain

which the ideas of Commissioner Mattoon are expressed, so that in case "Uncle Billy" says he never said it, he will have to hold the local daily to blame.

Considering the fact that Clackamas county spent for roads alone the sum of \$368,214.85 in 1914, it appears that Mr. Mattoon may well have been quoted correctly. And if he was quoted correctly, we are glad indeed to see a mark of dawning wisdom on the part of one, at least, of the members of the county court. The Courier hopes sincerely that the other members share the views ascribed to Mr. Mattoon, and that they will act upon the plan indicated.

For the expenditure of \$368,214.85, Clackamas county has remarkably little to show in the line of roads. The major portion of this vast sum—a third of a million dollars—must have been dumped into the open maw of the supervisor system, and the money expended on futile attempts to patch up the network of alleged roads that hinder the development of this neck of the Oregon woods. Practically no new roads were built in this county during 1914; and while the supervisors who worked at patching up the highways may have been honest in their efforts, they certainly did not get value received for the amount expended. The sum mentioned above, it must be remembered, includes only the cost of roads—it does not include such sums as were spent on bridges.

Probably no greater proof of the inadequacy of the system of having road supervisors could be shown than this total of the road tally sheet. The Courier has, from time to time, called attention to the fact that while individual road supervisors may be well-meaning and honest, the only real way to get good roads is to have highway work under the direction of trained

Wolf Howls

We note by last week's Courier that somebody else, aside from Doc Morris, reads these feeble attempts at humor and comment on the passing show. John Stark, the vitrolite writer, whose thoughts grace the Courier nearly every week, appears not to think much of these Wolf Howls, and says so—along with references to charity soup profoundly diluted which he believes will be dished out to the "Wolf" this coming winter. John Stark himself is a farmer, gets his living from the land, and so has nothing to fear; but poor hired pencil-pushers, who get only a stipend when subscriptions are paid up, had better beware of the coming famine. Especially when they give no indications of having brains. So says John Stark, as nearly as we can gather from a perusal of his remarks.

Well, like P. T. Barnum, the writer of these "Howls" doesn't care particularly what people say about him, as long as they say something. Doc Morris, our painstaking and painstaking (sometimes) dentist, has kicked at the "Howls," and John Stark has kicked. That shows that two people read them. Also, we are informed, the Rev. Dr. Milikin sometimes reads them—making three. And with three readers, maybe this column should be explained.

The pencil-pusher who writes these stuff isn't a bit stuck on it. But it is part of his job. You see, Tom Burke, lawyer, publicist, linotype operator and expert press agent for Gladstone, and maybe a few other things, started these Wolf Howls. Tom used to

and we'll go ahead with the rest of the dope.

One of the county seat's councilmen rushed in the other day and registered a kick against the sand dredge that is hauling the bed of the Willamette up for use on the Willamette Valley Southern railway and in mixing up the pavement of Main street. "If that dredge isn't stopped," said he, "it will ruin all the salmon nests along the bottom. Every time that scoop goes down and drags up a load of sand it probably destroys a dozen salmon nests, and pretty soon there won't be any place at all for the young fish to go at night to sleep." We asked him who told him about this havoc wrought to the "salmon nests," and he said Jack Albright had given him the information. Jack, we understand, doesn't want to kick on his own account, lest some folks will think he is prejudiced—as a fisherman.

Now there's a good chance for John Stark to say something more about brains.

And speaking of fish, an exchange has headlines that say "HOLDING FISH IS A NUISANCE." The article that follows deals with screens in tributary streams. True, brother—but holding fish isn't half as much of a nuisance as holding worms—ask any young lady about it.

The Peoria, Ill., Journal tells us that "F. H. Junk, representing a large automobile concern of Detroit, was in the city recently." Guess what kind of a car he is selling—with such a name.

The National Pickle Makers' Association, recently in convention, boasted that its members made 24 pickles a year for every man, woman and child in the United States. If pickles are the food of the loveless, there must be a lot of people who are not getting their two dozen—and a lot who are "hogging the trough."

Writing on beauty "in the world's greatest newspaper," which is published in Chicago, an "expert" says "I use cold water only on my face and neck." Query: What does she use when she washes her pearly ears—or doesn't she wash them?

Attorneys please notice: in the Washington circuit court A. L. Schie is suing J. S. Sparrow. That must be a bird of a case, eh, boys?

The "agricultural expert" of the Yorkshire (England) Post recently called attention to the value of deep cultivation. He says the results of deep trenching have surprised British farmers who have tried it. Yea, verily, ho; and the results of deep trenching by the English in Flanders have also surprised the Germans. Trenching ought to be popular abroad just now.

That being a farm joke, maybe John Stark will snicker at it.

The census bureau has recently issued a bulletin on Indians in the United States. Some of the subjects

dealt with are "sex," "age," "martial condition," "polygamy," "illiteracy," "inability to speak English" and "Indians taxed and not taxed." That doesn't sound very hopeful for Lo, the poor Indian.

The Cottage Grove Sentinel tells us that a young lady from that town went 20 miles to visit friends at a ranch, and when there took her shoes off. Wood rats stole her shoes, and as none of the footwear at the ranch would fit her toes, the maid had to go home 20 miles barefoot. Which is tragic—but why, we wonder, did she take her shoes off in the first place?

A simple effective glue, that is harmless, colorless and odorless, can be made by boiling tapioca in water," says an exchange. Now we know what was the matter with the pudding at the restaurant yesterday—the cook must have made too much glue, and rather than waste it put it on the bill of fare.

The Courier for job printing.

WOMEN WHO ARE ALWAYS TIRED

May Find Help in This Letter.

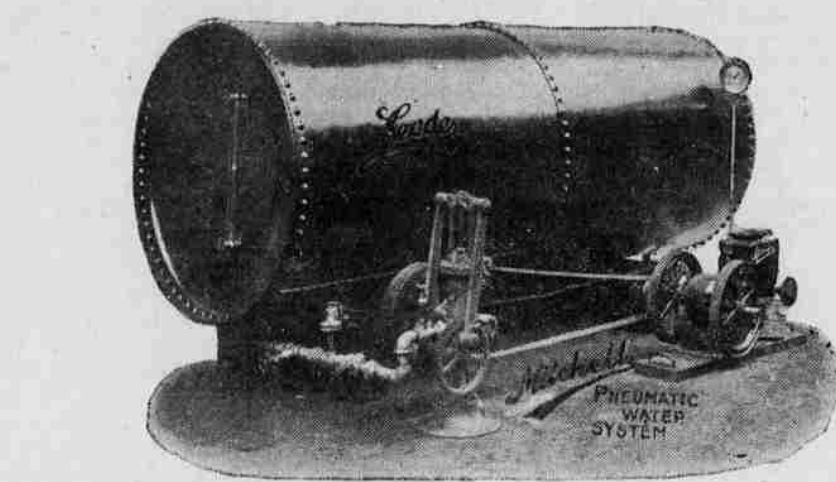
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through neglect or overwork I get run down and my appetite is poor and I have that weak, languid, always tired feeling, I get a bottle of Lydia E. Pinkham's Vegetable Compound, and it builds me up, gives me strength, and restores me to perfect health again. It is truly a great blessing to women, and I cannot speak too highly of it. I take pleasure in recommending it to others."—Mrs. ANNIE CAMERON, R.F.D., No. 1, Swan Creek, Michigan.

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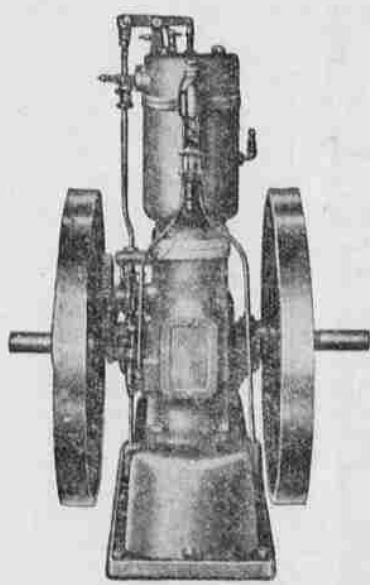


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truths. He told them the women of the civilized nations were rebelling against bearing children to feed machine guns and he characterized churches and governments as machines working together for their own aggrandisement continually, and when these machines are attacked "they fight without mercy or morality."

"If Roosevelt is right, then Jesus was the greatest mollycoddle that ever lived, for he never killed anybody, and he never advised murder."—(Benton County Courier.)

SOMETHING TO TRY.

According to the Enterprise, County Commissioner Mattoon says the county court is displeased with the supervisor system of road construction, and is considering dividing the county into four parts and placing each section in charge of a competent roadmaster, who would be given free rein in hiring such help as he needed; being held accountable only to the court for the quality of work done.

The Enterprise says Commissioner Mattoon "described the supervisor system as extravagant and wasteful" and "was convinced that the county was losing money from the road fund in large amounts annually."

The Courier takes pains to quote the Enterprise as the medium through

and competent highway engineers. It costs money to hire such men, but the money given them in salaries is well spent, as under their direction the expenditure of road funds will return value for the investment. Roads cannot be built out of a mere pile of dirt in the Oregon country—they must have proper foundations, must be correctly drained; and to meet modern traffic conditions they must also be correctly surfaced. Filling in holes with river gravel that will not cement itself together will not patch worn spots—in short all road work should be designed by a man who has made a study of road materials and road construction.

The Courier hopes the day is drawing near when the county court will not only see this, but will act on the idea. One thing is certain; it will not cost any more to make the experiment, and it will not waste the road funds any more than they are now wasted as political spoil, or as a diversion among the lucky of enough money to pay taxes. Clackamas county has vast resources, it is ideally situated, it should be the mecca of all who come to Oregon. To thus meet its destiny it must have good roads—and the abolishing of the road supervisor system will be the first step in the right direction.

Let the county court give it a trial. Linotype to put in a three-star dash

go to the University of Oregon along with Dean Collins, who is the official funny man and poet of the Oregonian, and maybe Tom caught the germ from Dean. At any rate, Tom started it; and when the present humble scribe got hooked on to the Courier staff, he was ordered to keep the "Wolf" howling or have his salary cut. And needing the salary to pay jitters fumes and to buy breakfast food for his family, he bowed to the inevitable and did what he could with the Wolf Howls. He knows they aren't as interesting as when Tom Burke peddled them; but he never aspires to rise to Tom's heights of humor. And maybe if enough people write in good strong kicks to the boss of this sheet, telling him how punk the Wolf Howls are—why maybe the boss will order the "Wolf" killed, and will turn in his hide for county bounty. This is herewith explained, just for the benefit of John Stark, Doc Morris and any other objectors that may be floating around.

But as far as this week is concerned, the "Wolf Howls" have to written as usual, so here goes for some more agony. If you don't think it will repay the effort for reading it, pass it up—it has got to fill its allotted space on this page, so that the advertising may be surrounded with "pure reading matter" as per contract. With this foreword, we will ask the fair



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